

phone and all the new feature sets. EPOC, an OS developed by Psion software in the UK, slowly evolved into the Symbian OS with the help and foresight of the leaders in the mobile phone industry way back in 1998.

The Symbian OS was designed to support the next-generation mobile phones—not the ones that were available when company was founded. The flexibility of the Symbian OS was obvious right from the first open Symbian OS phones—the Sony Ericsson P800, the Nokia 9200 series and the Nokia 7650. These phones were very different from each other



Nokia 7650 and Sony Ericsson P800 running same Symbian OS but with different (customised) User Interface

despite their using the same OS; this reveals how a mobile manufacturer can implement their ideas freely on a Symbian.

With support from the open source community, the Symbian OS has been able to provide licensees with cost-effective solutions. In this way, feature-rich mobile phones have been made available to the masses at affordable rates.

The new Symbian OS v9 uses different IDEs or compilers to develop OS functionality and applications based on the type of phone and target audience. It supports ARM's RealView compiler, Code Warrior v3.0 IDE, free GCC 3.4 compiler and the new, free Eclipse-based IDE for the purposes mentioned above. In order to make things a bit clear, let's take a look at how these compilers/IDEs are used.

The Eclipse-based IDE was designed by Symbian to develop phones for the entry level market. Phones for professionals work-